

Option C - Full IP Assignment

This is a discussion draft, not a legal agreement or legal advice. It describes the highest-control route: investor or company acquires Fieldstate IP after full payment and agreed protections.

Not legal advice. Subject to counsel review.

Plain-English summary

If the investor wants full IP ownership and low or no founder equity for Razim, the structure should be priced as an asset transfer, not as a normal MVP sprint. Retainer pays for delivery time. Assignment price pays for ownership. IP assignment happens only after full payment or agreed milestone escrow release.

Commercial purpose

This route is best when the investor wants acquisition/work-for-hire style ownership rather than a founder-led venture. It gives the investor maximum control, but it requires materially higher cash terms and careful transfer mechanics.

What investor gets

- Full ownership of the defined Fieldstate project IP after payment/assignment trigger.
- Ability to continue the product through their own company/team after transfer.
- Defined handover materials, source, documentation, and evidence artifacts.
- Optional continued delivery by Razim under a separate retainer.

What Razim keeps/protects

- Ownership until assignment trigger occurs.
- Payment before transfer.
- Background tooling and generic methods carve-out.
- No broad non-compete beyond the assigned Fieldstate scope.
- Optional reduced equity/warrants if Razim remains involved or cash price is discounted.

Indicative cost breakdown

Table:

* Item | Indicative range | Notes

Assignment price | GBP 300k-750k+ | Current build plus MVP v2 path; final price depends on scope and rights.

Founder/operator retainer | GBP 12k-25k/month | If Razim remains delivery lead during or after assignment.

Escrow/deposit | Negotiated | Protects both sides before final transfer.

Optional equity/warrants | 0%-10% | Only if cash price, ongoing role, or future upside justify it.

Advanced model/data programme | Separately budgeted | Licensed data, GPU training, validation, and production ML excluded unless added.

Legal/tax/accounting | Separately budgeted | Required for assignment, warranties, carve-outs, and transfer mechanics.

IP mechanics

- Razim owns Fieldstate IP until the assignment trigger.
- Assignment trigger should be full payment, escrow release, or milestone payment completion.
- Assignment should be to a company vehicle where possible, not to an individual person.
- Assignment scope must define what transfers and what does not transfer.
- Background IP, generic tooling, personal know-how, and reusable evaluation

patterns should be carved out.

- If payment fails, transfer does not occur and investor receives only any expressly paid-for limited rights.

Investor protection

- Assignment documents can be pre-agreed and held pending payment.
- Milestone escrow can release rights in stages.
- Handover checklist can define source, documentation, evidence artifacts, and operational instructions.
- Warranties can be limited to Razim's actual knowledge and authored work.
- Post-transfer support can be provided under a separate services retainer.

Razim protection

- No full assignment at sprint-tier pricing.
- No assignment before full payment or escrow release.
- No assignment to an individual if a company vehicle is intended.
- No broad non-compete or restriction beyond the defined assigned project.
- Background tooling and generic methods licence-back/carve-out.
- Counsel approval before any IP assignment signature.

Open issues for counsel

- Exact assignment scope and excluded background IP.
- Escrow mechanics and staged release of rights.
- Warranty scope and limitation of liability.
- Treatment of third-party/open-data dependencies.
- Ongoing support obligation, if any.
- Whether any royalty, revenue share, or option to participate remains after assignment.

Counsel review note

This draft is for commercial discussion only. Full IP assignment should not be signed without specialist legal review.